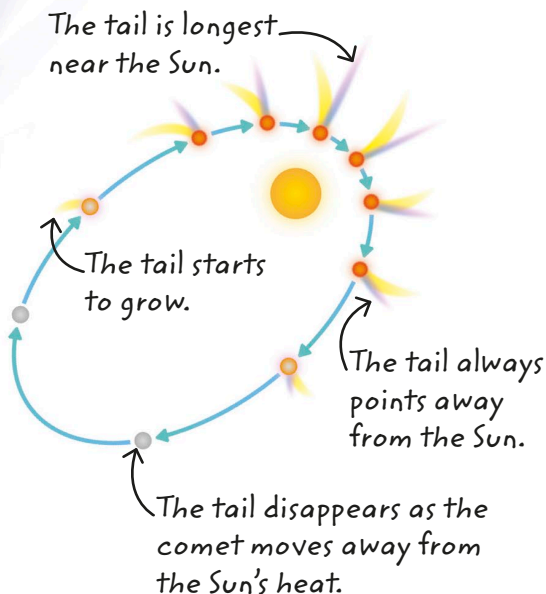


Halley's return

Some comets can be seen again and again in the night sky. A comet called Halley's Comet orbits the Sun once every 76 years or so. Comets like Halley's don't last forever. They lose material as they travel. If Earth moves through this material, we see a meteor shower in the night sky.



A light shower

During a meteor shower, streaks of light cross the night sky as rocky material burns up in our atmosphere. Meteors are also called shooting stars. Look out for the Geminids shower, which occurs around December 7–17 every year. You can see up to 50 shooting stars in an hour.



Arizona crater

Large space rocks that are too big to burn up in the atmosphere crash into Earth's surface. These are called meteorites. The big Barringer meteorite made this 0.7-mile- (1.2-km-) wide crater in Arizona in the United States around 50,000 years ago.